

Monuments of SLOTH

Infrastructure is touted as the cure for the slowdown, but project delays are going to cost the Government over Rs 39,000 crore

| By Nivedita Mukherjee |

It is the favourite mantra of policy makers, politicians and prescribing economists. And they chant it relentlessly as an antidote to recession and a supplement to boost growth. Tragically though, for all the chanting of the infrastructure mantra the Government has not been able to change the religion of sloth on the ground. About 423 projects of the 925 in the Central sector cutting across critical sectors are facing huge delays and cost overruns attributed to delays in land acquisition and clearances, slow award of contracts and poor performance of contractors. This means five out of 10 Central projects are facing delays in years and adding crores in cost overruns, according to the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MOSPI). Approval for many projects dates back to the early

RAILWAYS

◀ UDHAMPUR-SRINAGAR-BARAMULLA SECTION
Location: J&K
Date of approval: March 1995
Delay: 141 months

FREIGHT OPERATIONS INFORMATION SYSTEM
Location: All India
Date of approval: March 1984
Delay: 180 months

YASIN DAR